INCH-POUND

A-A-20047C
May 17, 1994
SUPERSEDING
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COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

MEAT PUREES, WITH MEAT BROTHS, CANNED

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers meat purees, with meat broths, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

Salient characteristics.

The meat purees shall conform to the type as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order. If purchaser wishes to include ingredients other than those in the descriptions, the ingredients must be specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order. Unless otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the food item shall be manufactured not more than 180 days prior to delivery.

Types.

Type I - Beef puree, with beef broth
Type II - Lamb puree, with lamb broth
Type III - Veal puree, with veal broth
Type IV - Chicken puree, with chicken broth
Type V - Pork puree, with pork broth

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.

FSC 8905

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Processing. The meat purees shall be prepared in accordance with good commercial practice.

Raw ingredients. The fresh and/or frozen beef/lamb/veal/chicken/pork (as appropriate by Type) shall be the only meat/poultry ingredient. At least 65 percent of the product formulation shall be uncooked and/or cooked meat/poultry (as appropriate by Type), and water shall be the only other ingredient permitted, i.e., no salt, monosodium glutamate, or other additives are permitted. The meat purees shall contain no meat byproducts or variety meats.

Finished product.

Odor and flavor: The meat puree (as appropriate by Type) with corresponding broth shall possess the odor and flavor typical of the Type. Presence of burnt, scorched, rancid, sour, or other objectionable odors or flavors shall cause rejection of the lot.

Consistency: The consistency shall be smooth, homogeneous, and such that after stirring and emptying from the container to a dry flat surface, possesses a heavy, creamy consistency, forms a slightly mounded mass, and that at the end of 2 minutes there is practically no separation of free liquid (including fat). Thin or watery product is not acceptable. Failure to meet above consistency requirements shall cause rejection of the lot.

Texture: Presence of graininess, lumpiness, or grittiness that materially affects eating quality shall cause rejection of the lot.

Defects: Presence of bone, cartilage, or ligaments greater than ⅛ inch (0.3175 cm) in any dimension shall cause rejection of the lot.

Protein content: The average protein content of the meat purees shall not be less than 13.0 percent and the protein percentage of the meat purees in any individual container shall not be less than 11.5 percent.

Fat content: The average fat content of the beef, lamb, and pork puree shall not exceed 9.0 percent and the fat percentage of the beef, lamb, and pork puree in any individual container shall not exceed 10.0 percent. The average fat content of the veal puree shall not exceed 8.0 percent and the fat percentage of the veal puree in any individual container shall not exceed 9.0 percent. The average fat content of the chicken puree shall not exceed 10.0 percent and the fat percentage of the chicken puree in any individual container shall not exceed 11.3 percent.

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Foreign material: Acceptability of product with respect to the presence of foreign material (e.g.; glass, dirt, hair, insect parts, wood, or metal, etc.) shall be made by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations employee.

Analytical requirements.

Chemical analyses shall be made in accordance with the following methods in the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC as specified below:

Test	Method
Fat 1/	960.39, 976.21, or 985.15
Protein 2/	928.08

1/ The lot shall be rejected if the average fat percentage or fat percentage in any individual container is more than specified.

2/ The lot shall be rejected if the average protein percentage or protein percentage in any individual container is less than specified.

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The meat component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture. The delivered meat purees shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product within the commercial marketplace. Delivered meat purees shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Meat and Poultry Products Inspection Acts and regulations promulgated thereunder.

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Quality assurance.

When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the Meat Grading and Certification Branch, Livestock and Seed Division, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS), U.S. Department of Agriculture, will determine the quality assurance of the meat purees according to Meat Grading and Certification Branch procedures. The meat purees shall be examined or tested in accordance with the criteria contained in the salient characteristics of this CID and Table I, and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers currently in effect on the date of the solicitation.

Withdrawal of samples for fat and protein content analyses. After completion of the can filling and heat processing operations for each lot, 9 cans of product shall be randomly selected from the lot. These 9 cans shall be randomly distributed as follows:

- Three shall be submitted to the laboratory for analysis.

- Three shall be submitted to the contractor.

- Three shall be retained by the AMS agent as a reserve sample.

Analysis of reserve samples at the request of the contractor shall not be permitted unless the original analysis indicated that the involved lot will be discounted or rejected because of noncompliance with the fat or protein content requirement. When the reserve sample is analyzed, the analyses for both fat and protein shall be made and will be considered final. Unused reserve samples shall be returned to the contractor for inclusion in subsequent lots.

End item inspection: The end item lot size, expressed as number of cans, shall be declared to the AMS agent by the contractor. Meat purees from open cans used for product examination shall remain the property of the contractor.

Product examination: The finished product shall be examined for the salient characteristics of this CID. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed can. Cans selected for examination must be free from damage. The sample size shall be as specified in Table I. Failure of the sample to meet the salient characteristics of this CID shall be cause for rejection of the lot. The product shall be examined at a temperature of 70 to 80°F (21.1 to 26.7°C).

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TABLE I. Sampling criteria for product certification

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (cans) (number of sample units)
3,200 or less	8
3,201 to 10,000	13
10,001 to 35,000	20

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The meat puree products shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

For Department of Defense procurement.

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer.

A. Commercial packaging. Fifteen ounces or one pound (425.2 or 454 g) of meat puree shall be packaged in a metal can in accordance with commercial practice.

B. Export packaging. Fifteen ounces or one pound (425.2 or 454 g) of meat puree shall be packaged in an open-top style, round metal can with soldered (lead-free) or welded side seam and compound-lined, double-seamed ends. The can shall be made throughout from not less than 0.25 pound per base box electrolytic tinplate. The can shall have a sufficient baseplate weight and temper to protect the meat puree during shipment and storage. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to Type I, or when specified, Type III of TT-C-495.

C. Commercial packing. Twelve cans of meat puree, of one type only, shall be packed in a fiberboard container complying with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable, except metal fasteners shall not be used in the final closure of the box. The cans shall be packed on end, four in length, three in width, and one in depth within the box.

D. Export packing. Twelve cans of meat puree, of one type only, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, grade W5c or W5s of ASTM D 5118. The cans shall be packed on end, four in length, three in width, and one in depth, within a container. Each shipping container shall be reinforced with

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nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament-reinforced tape in accordance with ASTM D 1974.

E. **Labeling.** Labeling of cans shall be in accordance with commercial practice and be in compliance with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder. The sodium content of the product shall be shown on the label.

F. **Commercial unit loads.** Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with Type III, Class G of MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

G. **Export unit loads.** Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with Type I, Class A of MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

H. **Marking (commercial and export).** Marking of unit packs, shipping containers, and unit loads shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

Notes.

Sources of documents.

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
2200 Mill Road
Alexandria, VA 22314

Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

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Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC may be obtained from:

AOAC International
2200 Wilson Boulevard
Suite 400
Arlington, VA 22201-3301

Copies of ASTM D 5118, Practice for Fabrication of Fiberboard Boxes and ASTM D 1974, Practice for Methods of Closing, Sealing, and Reinforcing Fiberboard Shipping Containers may be obtained from:

ASTM
1916 Race Street
Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187

Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations are contained in 9 CFR Part 200 to end. Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1-199. These documents may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402-0001

Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 783-3238.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from:

Chairperson
Condition of Container Committee
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 2506, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

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Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specifications Unit (3FB-WS)
Room 6654
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4, Section D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity:

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

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